

Should India not go in for manufacturing of electronics goods in a big way like China? Why don't we become designers and service providers for the world?" he asked. "It seems clear to me that if we can make India a great manufacturing hub, we shall be able to generate more employment and opportunities, specially for those who are not well educated and people from the villages and small towns. India needs to set a benchmark to succeed. Who knows, a day will soon come when India will become a benchmark for the whole world. Of course, for that we shall have to work hard relentlessly," he emphasised.

Agreeing to Chopra's thoughts, R. Chandrashekar said that the government has now seriously decided to encourage local manufacturing of electronics goods. "A report submitted by a Task Force Committee on December 11, 2009, has reflected that it's no longer a government vs industry situation, and that the time has come when the government needs to work together with the industry for its growth." Appreciating the summit for its topical theme, Chandrashekar said, "On the IT/ITES front we have already achieved successes but current emphasis is on how to extend the success in the electronics sector in many ways. This emphasis is also a recognition of the huge importance of the electronics sector and, unlike the software and services sector, here success means meeting our own rising and exploding demands. Huge growth has been projected for the electronics sector."

Chandrashekar said that the question that arises is whether this exploding demand will be met substantially by imports, or will it lead to an opportunity for domestic manufacturing. The government has now realised that it can no longer set up expectations for the industry but instead is ready to work hand-in-hand with the industry to meet the demand. He put forth the advantages of having local manu-

facturing in India as India has the expertise in innovative design and products, R&D capabilities and demographic populations consisting of a large youth population.

Opening the floor to the panel discussion, Chandrashekar concluded, "This will create huge employment opportunities. Currently, the electronics industry employs around 4.4 million people. This number is expected to grow to 16.1 million in 2014 and 27.8 million in 2020."

Session 1: Emerging Markets in India—The Untapped and Upcoming Business

Jaswinder Ahuja, corporate vice president and managing director, Cadence Design Systems, India, was the first to speak. During his presentation he pointed out that 4G phones, smart grid power, medical electronics, video and solar will drive the growth of the electronics industry. "From \$45 billion in 2009, the expected domestic demand will increase to US\$ 125 billion by 2014—22 per cent annual rise. "India is highly under penetrated and there is huge headroom to grow and exploit the untapped opportunities," he said.

Gurjit S. Bharara, business head, solar group, Reliance Industries Ltd, provided yet another perspective as he pointed out that solar was an emerging market, with India itself holding 89,000 TW potential. He said that the government had promised 20,000 MW solar power by 2022 under the Solar Mission, extending support worth Rs 900 billion! "Moreover there is a huge demand for grid connected solar panels to illuminate Indian villages. India will become a \$75 billion solar market by 2022," he said.

P.K. Sood, chairman, Regnart Group of Companies, raised another important point—"India has untapped opportunities in power electronics for lighting and renewable energy applications—but is India prepared for this?" According to



Speakers at the EFY Summit 2009: (L to R) Indeevar G., GM, sales and marketing, Amara Raja Electronics Ltd, Jaswinder Ahuja, corporate vice president and MD, Cadence Design System India, G.S. Bharara, business head (North), Solar group, Reliance Industries Ltd, P. K. Sood, chairman, Regnart Group of Companies



Speakers at the EFY Summit 2009: (L to R) Philip Jacob, general manager, development and engineering, Bharat Electronics, Neelam Kumar, executive director, Aiplab Ltd, P. Venkatram, consultant, ICT, P.K. Dutta, member secretary, TePP, department of scientific and industrial research